

Deccan Power & Gas Utilities Ltd

Powering Homes · Fueling Progress

Frequently Asked Questions — Consumer Guide

This document contains answers to the most frequently asked questions by consumers of Deccan Power & Gas Utilities Ltd. For further assistance, contact our 24x7 helpline: 1800-XXX-XXXX.

BILLING QUESTIONS

Q: Why is my electricity bill higher than last month?

A: Your bill may be higher due to one or more of the following reasons: increased consumption (e.g., use of air conditioners, geysers, or heaters in extreme weather), a catch-up bill after an estimated bill was issued in the previous month, revision of tariff rates, or addition of new electrical appliances. You can check unit-wise consumption on our self-service portal or mobile app. If the increase seems unreasonable, you may request a meter inspection.

Q: What is an estimated bill and why did I receive one?

A: An estimated bill is issued when our meter reader is unable to physically access your meter (e.g., premises locked, meter inaccessible). The bill amount is estimated based on your average consumption over the previous 3 months. Once an actual reading is taken in the subsequent month, the difference is adjusted — either charged or credited on your next bill.

Q: How is my bill calculated if there was a tariff revision mid-month?

A: In such cases, the bill is split into two sub-periods: units consumed before the revision date are billed at the old rate, and units consumed after the revision date are billed at the new rate. The meter reading data from our system is used for this pro-rata calculation.

Q: What is Fuel Surcharge Adjustment (FSA)?

A: FSA is a variable charge that recovers the cost of fuel (coal, gas) used to generate electricity. It varies monthly based on the actual fuel cost index notified by the State Electricity Regulatory Commission. It is applied as a surcharge per unit consumed and is shown separately on your bill.

Q: I paid my bill but it still shows as unpaid — what should I do?

A: Payments made through banks or payment counters may take 2 to 3 working days to reflect. Online payments via our portal or app are usually updated within 4 hours. If your payment is not reflected after 3 working days, please contact our billing helpdesk with your payment receipt or transaction ID.

METER QUESTIONS

Q: How do I read my electricity meter?

A: For a standard digital meter, note the reading displayed on the LCD screen (usually 5 digits). The reading represents the total units (kWh) consumed since installation. Your monthly consumption is the difference between the current month's reading and the previous month's reading. For smart meters, readings are available in real time on our consumer portal.

Q: I suspect my meter is faulty — how do I get it checked?

A: You can raise a meter inspection request through our consumer portal, mobile app, or helpline. A technician will be assigned within 3 working days. If the meter is found faulty after testing at our approved testing lab, it will be replaced at no cost. If the meter is found accurate, a testing fee of Rs. 200 (domestic) will be charged.

Q: What is a smart meter and what are its benefits?

A: A smart meter is a digital meter that records electricity consumption at 15-minute intervals and transmits the data automatically to our system. Benefits include: no estimated bills, real-time usage monitoring on your phone, Time-of-Use tariff eligibility, instant disconnection/reconnection, and tamper alerts. Smart meter installation is free for existing consumers under the national rollout program.

PAYMENT QUESTIONS

Q: What are the available payment options?

A: You can pay your utility bill through: (1) Online — our official website or mobile app using debit/credit card, net banking, UPI, or wallets. (2) Auto-pay — link your bank account or card for automatic monthly deduction. (3) Payment centres — visit any of our 45 authorised payment centres across the city. (4) Bank counters — at designated partner bank branches. (5) Cash — at our divisional offices. Online payments receive instant confirmation.

Q: How do I set up auto-pay for my utility bills?

A: Log in to our consumer portal at www.dpgu-utility.in, go to 'Payment Settings', and select 'Set up Auto-Pay'. Link your bank account (NACH mandate) or card. Auto-pay deducts the bill amount 3 days before the due date and sends an SMS confirmation. You can cancel auto-pay anytime from the same settings page.

Q: What happens if my auto-pay fails?

A: If an auto-pay deduction fails (insufficient balance, card expiry, etc.), you will receive an SMS and email alert. You will need to make a manual payment before the due date to avoid late payment surcharges. Three consecutive auto-pay failures will result in automatic cancellation of the auto-pay facility.

CONNECTION & DISCONNECTION

Q: How do I apply for a new electricity connection?

A: Applications for new connections can be submitted online at our portal or at any divisional office. Required documents: (1) Proof of ownership or tenancy agreement, (2) Photo ID (Aadhaar/PAN), (3)

Site plan / wiring diagram, (4) Load requirement details. Processing time: 7 working days for domestic connections, 15 working days for commercial. The security deposit and connection fee must be paid at the time of application.

Q: How do I request a temporary disconnection?

A: Temporary disconnection (e.g., if you are relocating for several months) can be requested at the divisional office with a minimum notice of 7 days. Fixed charges continue to apply during temporary disconnection. Reconnection can be done upon your return by paying a reconnection fee of Rs. 300 (domestic) and clearing all outstanding dues.

COMPLAINTS & ESCALATION

Q: How do I lodge a complaint about a power outage?

A: Outages can be reported through: (1) Our 24x7 helpline 1800-XXX-XXXX, (2) WhatsApp helpdesk at +91-XXXXXX-XXXXXX, (3) Consumer portal — 'Report Outage' section, (4) Mobile app. You will receive a complaint reference number. Scheduled maintenance outages are notified 24 hours in advance via SMS. Emergency outages are typically restored within 4 hours in urban areas.

Q: My complaint has not been resolved — how do I escalate?

A: If your complaint is not resolved within the committed timeline (shown in your complaint acknowledgement), you may escalate to: Level 1 — Divisional Manager (contact via portal). Level 2 — Zonal Superintendent. Level 3 — Consumer Grievance Redressal Forum (CGRF) — a statutory body that handles unresolved complaints. CGRF complaints must be filed within 30 days of the unresolved complaint.